

Skills Summary

Teen Numbers: Numerals and Number Words

Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.

Skill 1 — A teen number is one ten and some ones

Rule:

Every teen number is built the same way: **one ten + some ones**.

- Fill a ten-frame all the way: that is the ten.
- The extra dots are the ones.
- In the numeral, the left digit 1 always means *one ten* — never one.

Example: One full ten-frame and 5 extra dots. Write the numeral.

Step 1. The full frame is a whole ten, so start counting at ten instead of at one.

Step 2. Count on 5 more: 11, 12, 13, 14, 15. That is $10 + 5 \Rightarrow$ **15**

Try it: One full ten-frame and 8 extra dots. Write the numeral.

check: **18**

Skill 2 — Reading and writing teen number words

Rule:

The ending **-teen** means “and one ten”. Hear the ones part first, then add the ten.

- four + teen $\rightarrow$ 4 ones and one ten.
- Learn the three that hide their pattern: **eleven**, **twelve**, and **thirteen** (three), **fifteen** (five).

Example: Write 16 as a number word, and say how many ones it has.

Step 1. Reading a numeral into a word: name the ones, then say *-teen* for the ten.

Step 2. Take the ten off the numeral to find the ones: $16 - 10$ leaves 6, so the word is **sixteen**. $\Rightarrow$ **6** ones

Try it: Write the numeral for **nineteen**.

check: **19**

Skill 3 — Comparing two teen numbers

Rule:

Two teen numbers both have one ten, so the tens cannot decide it — **compare the ones**. Fewer ones means the smaller number.

$<$ means *is less than*. $>$ means *is greater than*. The open side always faces the bigger number.

Example: Write $<$ or $>$ between 12 and 16.

Step 1. Both are teen numbers with one ten each, so the tens tie and only the ones matter.

Step 2. 12 has 2 ones, 16 has 6 ones; 2 ones is fewer than 6 ones. $\Rightarrow$ $12 < 16$

Try it: Write $<$ or $>$ between 18 and 11.

$<$ check

(!) Watch out: In 15 the digit 1 is worth *ten*, not one. A student who reads it as “one and five” gets 6 or thinks 14 are loose when a ten is bagged. Say the ten first, every time.